

Acer India

Twenty-Seven Years Setting Trends Under the leadership of Harish Kohli

When Harish Kohli joined Acer India in 1999 as General Manager – Sales, the Indian PC market was nascent and deeply uncertain. He never left. What he has built since is a masterclass in institutional depth —and it is now paying dividends at scale.

The technology industry celebrates speed. The pivot, the disruption, the unicorn built in five years and sold in seven — these are the stories that fill conference keynotes and business school case studies. Harish Kohli has spent twenty-seven years building a different kind of story. Deeper. More durable. And increasingly, more relevant.

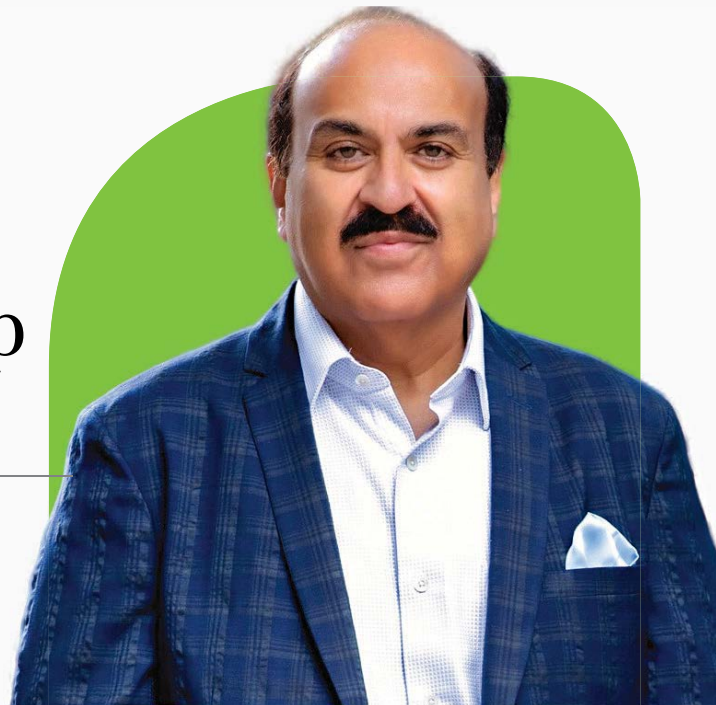
As President and Managing Director of Acer India, Kohli oversees an organisation that has evolved far beyond the PC brand he joined in 1999. Today, Acer India has built a Make in India manufacturing ecosystem spanning laptops, desktops, all-in-one PCs, tablets, servers and workstations, Televisions, ACs and more — a commitment Kohli championed long before local manufacturing became a national priority. Its channel partner network, anchored by relationships dating to his earliest years with the company, has proven more resilient than any single product cycle the industry has thrown at it. According to IDC,

Harish Kohli
President and
Managing Director
of Acer India

Acer emerged as India's No. 2 PC brand in the first quarter of 2026, marking an important milestone in its growth journey.

That growth has also been driven by deliberate diversification. Acer India has expanded beyond its traditional computing base into gaming through Predator and Nitro, AI PCs with neural processing capabilities, consumer electronics and smart appliances under Acerpure, enterprise servers and AI infrastructure through Altos, and technology-enabled services through Highpoint Service Network. Together, these businesses reflect Acer's transition from a PC company into a broader hardware, software and services organisation.

This growth has been accompanied by a strong commitment to social impact. Through Project Humanity, Acer India supports initiatives that provide free medical care in under-served tribal regions, dialysis treatment for underprivileged patients, environmental restoration through tree planting, and other community-focused programmes. Its CSR efforts also include VisioNova, an integrated technology solution supporting children with Cortical Visual Impairment. These initiatives demonstrate how Acer is applying its resources, partnerships and technology capabilities to improve access to healthcare, strengthen communities and create a more sustainable future.



"Every challenge and crisis is a chance for growth," he says. "The question is whether your fundamentals are enough to let you emerge stronger. At Acer India, we have always invested in those fundamentals — distribution depth, manufacturing credibility and customer relationships — precisely because we knew the disruptions would come."

They came repeatedly. The dotcom bust. Demonetisation. The pandemic. The global chip shortage. Each time, the institutional architecture Kohli helped build absorbed the shock and enabled the business to adapt while protecting its long-term direction.

The next chapter is already being written: Rapid expansion of exclusive brand stores with Tier II and Tier III market focus, AI PC leadership, Acerpure scaling across home appliances, Altos strengthening enterprise AI infrastructure, and Highpoint Service Network building Acer's services capabilities.

"We are focused on scaling our presence beyond PCs into consumer electronics, smart appliances, enterprise infrastructure, services and healthcare," Kohli says. "Our focus remains on innovation, customer-centricity and sustainable growth."

Twenty-seven years. One company. One leader who understood that in technology, the longest competitive advantage is not the fastest product — it is the deepest institution.